

Maria P. Perez Arguelles

RESEARCH ASSISTANT PREFESSOR

Hobby School of Public Affairs, Houston, TX

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Academic Positions

2025-Present	Research Assistant Professor , Hobby School of Public Affairs, University of Houston
2022-2025	Research Associate , Hobby School of Public Affairs, University of Houston
2020-2022	Researcher , Hobby School of Public Affairs, University of Houston
2015-2020	Graduate Research Assistant , Dept. of Landscape Architecture and Urban Planning, Texas A&M University
2017-2018	Graduate Research Assistant , Hazard Reduction and Recovery Center, Texas A&M University
2014-2015	Graduate Research Assistant , Dept. of Agricultural Economics, Texas A&M University
2012-2014	Graduate Teaching Assistant , Dept. of Agricultural Economics, Texas A&M University

Education

Texas A&M University	<i>College Station, TX</i>
PHD URBAN AND REGIONAL SCIENCE	2020
Dissertation title: Socio-Economic and Spatial Determinants of an Informality Spectrum: The Case of El Amate in Guatemala City	
Texas A&M University	<i>College Station, TX</i>
MS AGRICULTURAL ECONOMICS	2015
Thesis title: Analyzing Structural Changes and Trade Impacts in the Tomato Industry	
Universidad de los Andes	<i>Bogota, Colombia</i>
BS ECONOMICS	2012

Articles in Peered-Reviewed Journals

- Buttorff, G., Yuhsin A., Olapade, Y., **Perez, M.P.**, Pinto P.M., Sipole, S., Vallejo A. & Wong, M.C. (2026) **Watt's the Price of Keeping the Lights On? Natural Disasters and Willingness to Pay for Reliable Electricity**. *Energy Policy*, 216, 115362
- Adepoju, O., Xu, L., Chavez, S., Dang, P., Tipton, M., **Arguelles, M. P.**, Buttorff, Gail & Wong, M. C. (2025). **Back-to-Back Climate shocks and the mental health crisis: A Texas-sized surge in depression and anxiety ER visits**. *The American Journal of Emergency Medicine*.
- Safarova, B., Giusti, C. H., **Perez, M. P.**, Zecca, I. B., Carbajal, E. S., Hamer, G. L., & Hamer, S. A. (2021). **Habitat and environmental risks of Chagas disease in low-income colonias and peri-urban subdivisions in South Texas**. *Habitat International*. 118: 102460.
- Nozhati, S., Rosenheim, N., Ellingwood, B. R., Mahmoud, H., & **Perez, M.** (2019). **Probabilistic framework for evaluating food security of households in the aftermath of a disaster**. *Structure and Infrastructure Engineering*. 15(8): 1060-1074.
- Perez, M. P.**, Luis A. Ribera, & Marco A. Palma. (2017). **Effects of trade and agricultural policies on the structure of the US tomato industry**. *Food Policy*. 69: 123-134.
- Perez, M. P.**, Palma M., Behe B., & Hall C. (2016). **Structural Breaks and Future Growth of the Green Industry**. *Journal of Environmental Horticulture*. 34(2):52-55.

Book Chapters

Book Chapter: Giusti, C. H., **Perez, M. P.**, Ruiz Bode, I., & Hernandez, M. (2022). **El Amate in Guatemala City: An Urban Intervention**. In *Informality and the City: Theories, Actions and Interventions* (pp. 215230). Cham: Springer International Publishing.

Work in Progress

Bracing for the Storm: Ideal vs Actual Natural Disaster Preparedness in Texas. With: Agustin Vallejo, Gail J. Buttorff, Pablo M. Pinto, Savannah L. Sipole, & M. C. Sunny Wong

The expansion of the LRT in Houston and its effects on gentrification and property values. With: John Park & Agustin Vallejo

Customizing Global Vulnerability Indices for Local Use: The Role of Survey Data. With: Agustin Vallejo, Gail J. Buttorff, Pablo M. Pinto, Savannah L. Sipole, & M. C. Sunny Wong

Visualizing VRAP indicators for policy making in the community: the case of Houston. With: Gail J. Buttorff, Pablo M. Pinto, Savannah L. Sipole, Agustin Vallejo, & M. C. Sunny Wong

Powering Communities: Assessing the Social Impact of Clean Energy and Microgrids in Houston. With: Jian Shi

The expansion of the LRT in Houston and its effects on gentrification and property values. With: Park, J., Perez, Maria P. & Vallejo, A.

Texas winter storm and willingness to pay for electricity. With: Gail J. Buttorff, Yuhsin Annie Hsu, Yewande Olapade, Pablo M. Pinto, Savannah L. Sipole, Agustin Vallejo, & M. C. Sunny Wong.

Methodological Risk Assessment of In-formal markets in the city. With: Cecilia Giusti

Technical Reports

SNAP Rollbacks and Houston's Most Vulnerable Households. Hobby School of Public Affairs, University of Houston (November, 2025)

Understanding Household Energy Burden and Perceptions in Texas. Hobby School of Public Affairs, University of Houston (October, 2025)

Houston cares about climate change: policy preferences and partisan gaps. Hobby School of Public Affairs, University of Houston (September, 2025)

Household Economic Dynamics in the Greater Houston Area. Hobby School of Public Affairs, University of Houston (September, 2025)

Texas Metropolitan Blueprint: A Five-Year Policy Agenda for Action. Clark, J. H., Cross, R., Greenberg, S. R., Pedigo, S. W., Pinto, P. M., & Perez Arguelles, M. P. (2025)

Special Report on Outage Experiences and Preparedness in the Shadow of Hurricane Beryl Hobby School of Public Affairs, University of Houston (November, 2024)

Texas Trends: Climate Perceptions and Community Coping Strategies Hobby School of Public Affairs, University of Houston (November, 2024)

Texas Trends: Climate Change, Beliefs and Actions. Hobby School of Public Affairs, University of Houston (November, 2023)

Texas Trends: School Vouchers. Hobby School of Public Affairs, University of Houston (October, 2023)

Social Vulnerability and Natural Disasters: 5 Years After Hurricane Harvey. Hobby School of Public Affairs, University of Houston (July, 2022)

Texas Trends Survey 2021: Electric Vehicles. Hobby School of Public Affairs, University of Houston (February, 2022)

Reliability and the Texas Power Grid in the Aftermath of Winter Storm Uri. Hobby School of Public Affairs, University of Houston (June, 2021)

Economic Impacts of the COVID-19 Pandemic and the Distribution of PPP Loans in Austin. Hobby School of Public Affairs, University of Houston (July, 2021)

Media and Outreach

Presented at Texas Tribune Event. [A blueprint for Texas cities: Growth, challenges and opportunities](#) (March 5, 2025)

Quoted in [Survey: Texans who experience power outages, low-income residents perceive hotter summers](#). Dominic Anthony Walsh, Houston Public Media (August, 2024)

Quoted in [New survey shows opinions differ on causes, effects of extreme weather](#). Sally Strong, phys.org (November, 2023)

Quoted in [New survey confirms big gaps in Texas Health Care Availability and coverage](#). Sally Strong, University of Houston (October, 2022)

Quoted in [Why does Houston have so many immigrants? Here's how the Bayou City became so diverse](#). Elizabeth Trovall, Houston Chronicle (November, 2022)

Quoted in [A look at who moved to — and from — Harris County during the pandemic](#) Elizabeth Trovall, Houston Chronicle (August, 2022)

Presentation titled: "Social Vulnerability & Natural Disasters: 5 Years after Hurricane Harvey" at the Harris County Office of Homeland Security and Emergency Management, Getting it Right Workshop, October, 2022

Presentation titled: "Hispanics in Houston" at the Small Business Administration Hispanic Summit, October, 2022